

Latent flags

DINOv2 visual embeddings of 197 sovereign flags, projected to 2D. Borders mark hand-curated vexillological categories — soft hulls appear only where a category's flags genuinely cluster in the projection.

PCA

21% + 11% var

t-SNE

perplexity 20, cosine

PHATE

knn 10, decay 20



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|--|--|--|---|---|
|  Nordic cross (5) |  Pan-Arab (10) |  Pan-African (21) |  Communist red (6) |  Latin (charge) (10) |
|  British ensign (5) |  Star & crescent (12) |  Vertical tricolor (12) |  Stars & stripes (9) |  Pan-Slavic (8) |